# Upfront Rap Vocal

*Sounds like: modern rap vocal — dry, close, every word intelligible*

**ACCURACY B**

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

## WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

**`Channel strip (HPF + EQ + comp #1) -> MClass Compressor (#2) -> DDL-1 throw (send) -> RV7000 tiny room (send)`**

**Starting material:** condenser or SM7B, quiet room, rapper 4-6 inches off the mic

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## DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

**1.** Channel strip HPF: 90 Hz. Rap vocals carry no useful info below that; the 808 owns it.

**2.** Channel EQ: cut 2 dB at 400 Hz (boxiness), boost 1.5 dB at 5 kHz (presence). Less is more — modern rap vocals are clean, not scooped.

**3.** Channel comp: ratio 3:1, medium attack, ~3 dB reduction. First stage catches phrases.

**4.** MClass Compressor: ratio 4:1, fast attack, another ~3 dB. Second stage catches syllables. Two gentle stages sound transparent; one 6 dB stage sounds squeezed.

**5.** De-ess workaround: MClass EQ between the comps, cut 3–4 dB at 6–8 kHz narrow Q, ONLY if esses hurt. Crude but stock. (Real fix: free VST3 de-esser — Techivation T-De-Esser, $0.)

**6.** DDL-1 on a send: 1/4 note sync, feedback ~25, pan it. Automate the send up on the last word of a line — the classic "throw".

**7.** RV7000 on a send: Room, decay 0.4 s, barely audible. Rap vocals read "dry" but a touch of room stops the sterile-booth feel.

**Why this works**

Serial compression controls dynamics invisibly; the dryness keeps the voice in front of the beat instead of inside it.

**Why this order**

EQ cut before compression — otherwise the comps react to the 400 Hz mud you were going to remove anyway.

**Reason trick**

Automate the DDL-1 send in the sequencer lane rather than riding it live — draw a spike on the throw word. Perfectly repeatable.

**The skill you just learned**

Serial compression: split the workload across stages.

**Worth buying?**

De-esser is the one real hole; free VST3 fills it. No RE purchase justified.